

Fragrance Brand & Market Lens — SPACE across African Markets

Three observations on positioning a perfume portfolio for growth and share, with concrete moves.

Prepared by Paula De Francisco Pérez · 19 June 2026 · For: Brand Manager - Fragrances at SPACE

1. Positioning across heterogeneous African markets

Finding: A single perfume portfolio has to win in markets with very different price ceilings, scent preferences and channel structures (modern trade vs. open-market distribution).

Insight: Treating Africa as one market dilutes positioning; the brands that win segment by scent family and price tier per country rather than pushing one global story everywhere.

Recommendation: Build a per-country positioning grid (scent family × price tier × hero SKU) and concentrate launch and A&P firepower on 2–3 lead markets first — the same focus-then-scale approach I used leading NPD across 50+ markets at DoFreeze.

2. Fragrance assortment & SKU productivity

Finding: Perfume portfolios accumulate long tails of slow SKUs that absorb working capital and shelf space without driving share.

Insight: Disciplined SKU rationalisation plus a few well-timed trend-led launches usually moves share more than broad range extension.

Recommendation: Run a quarterly assortment review (bestseller protection + tail pruning + trend gaps such as Arabian/oud profiles) — I onboarded 30+ fragrance stores in two months at Miravia by leaning into exactly this trend-driven assortment discipline.

3. Influencer, sampling & trade activation as the growth engine

Finding: Fragrance is discovery-led: people buy what they smell and what they see worn — channels where ATL alone underperforms.

Insight: A coordinated influencer + sampling + trade-activation motion compounds: creators drive trial intent, sampling converts it, and trade execution captures it at the shelf.

Recommendation: Stand up a creator + sampling programme tied to retail activation calendars per market — I built one from zero to 25–50 creators per campaign at DoFreeze, with sampling/seeding across modern trade and quick-commerce.

These are first-pass observations from the outside; with access to SPACE's market and sell-out data I would pressure-test them fast. They reflect how I actually run fragrance brands — focus markets, disciplined assortment, and a discovery-led activation engine.